

Workbook 10: Work and Public Places Plan

Related article: Hearing Loss at Work and in Public Places

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Workbook: My Work and Public Places Communication Plan

Part 1: Where do I need support?

Check the places where hearing is difficult.

- ☐ Work meetings
- ☐ Phone calls
- ☐ Video calls
- ☐ Training sessions
- ☐ School or classes
- ☐ Medical appointments
- ☐ Pharmacies
- ☐ Banks or offices
- ☐ Restaurants
- ☐ Theaters
- ☐ Airports or train stations
- ☐ Places of worship
- ☐ Community events
- ☐ Public service counters
- ☐ Emergency or safety announcements
- ☐ Other: _____

My top three difficult places are:

1. ---
2. ---
3. ---

Part 2: What makes these places difficult?

Check what applies.

- Background noise
 - Speaker is far away
 - People talk over one another
 - Poor lighting
 - Speaker turns away
 - Room echo
 - Fast speech
 - Phone sound is unclear
 - Video-call audio is unclear
 - Public announcements are hard to hear
 - I miss names, numbers, or times
 - I cannot see the speaker's face
 - I feel tired from listening
 - I do not know what support to ask for
- The biggest barrier for me is:

Part 3: Supports I want to try

Check the supports that may help.

- Written instructions
- Email summaries
- Meeting agendas
- Meeting notes
- Captions for video calls
- Captioned phone option
- Remote microphone
- Assistive listening device
- Telecoil or hearing loop
- Preferential seating
- Quiet room or quieter seating
- Visual or vibrating alerts
- Text alerts

- One-speaker-at-a-time rule
- Communication partner support
- Other: _____

The first support I want to try is:

Part 4: My work communication plan

At work, I have difficulty with:

- Meetings
- Phone calls
- Video calls
- Training
- Group discussions
- Safety announcements
- Customer, client, or patient conversations
- Conversations in noise
- Informal conversations
- Other: _____

One specific work barrier is:

A support that may help is:

A phrase I can use:

Part 5: My appointment plan

Before medical or professional appointments, I will:

- Tell the office I have hearing loss
- Bring hearing aids or assistive technology
- Bring a communication partner if desired
- Ask for written instructions
- Prepare questions in advance
- Ask for a visit summary

- Use the patient portal for follow-up

During the appointment, I will:

- Ask the provider to face me
- Ask for rephrasing when needed
- Repeat back important information
- Ask for names, numbers, or instructions in writing
- Ask for clarification before leaving

One phrase I can use at appointments is:

Part 6: My public places plan

In public places, I will ask about:

- Assistive listening systems
- Captions
- Written information
- Quiet seating
- Accessible announcements
- Visual alerts
- Telecoil or hearing loop access
- Other: _____

A phrase I can use is:

Example:

“Do you have an assistive listening system or written information available?”

Part 7: My self-advocacy scripts

Practice these phrases.

- “I have hearing loss. Please face me when you speak.”
- “Could you write that down?”
- “Could you send that by email?”
- “Could you turn on captions?”
- “Can we move away from the noise?”
- “Please speak one at a time.”

- “I missed the last part. Could you rephrase it?”
- “Let me repeat that back to make sure I understood.”
- “Could you put the date and time in the chat?”
- “Is an assistive listening system available?”

My own script: